

Rating Area 2: North Central Rural Tier

Hub: Emporium / Coudersport | Counties: Cameron, Elk, Potter

21.5% PID-approved avg. individual rate hike	102% avg. net premium increase, 2026	443,024 PA enrollees as of June 1, 2026	160,000+ cumulative PA terminations
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THE STATEWIDE PICTURE

The federal enhanced premium tax credits expired December 31, 2025, and Congress has not restored them; combined with the Pennsylvania Insurance Department's (PID) approved 21.5% average individual-market rate increase, Pennie reports the average net premium for the affected population rose 102% for 2026 (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; Pennie, 2026a). Statewide, 85,000 people dropped Pennie coverage during Open Enrollment; as of June 1, 2026, cumulative cancellations exceed 160,000 and total enrollment stands at 443,024 (Pennie, 2026a, 2026b). Pennsylvania's own relief program, the Act 54 state subsidy, remains unfunded as the state budget missed its June 30, 2026 deadline for the fifth year running (Spotlight PA, 2026).

CARRIERS & RATES IN THIS AREA

The smallest and least populous of Pennsylvania's nine rating areas, served by a concentrated Geisinger/Highmark carrier mix (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025b). Pennsylvania's Section 1332 reinsurance program offsets an estimated 4% of what 2026 premiums would otherwise be here and statewide (Capital Advantage Assurance Company, 2025), but that buffer is modest against the scale of the federal subsidy loss.

WHY RURAL RATING AREAS FEEL THE CLIFF HARDEST

Thin carrier competition, longer drive times to specialists, and older average enrollee age all push baseline premiums higher here before the subsidy cliff is even factored in. County-by-county termination and cost data for this area is published directly by Pennie and updated regularly — see pennie.com/affordability for the current county map rather than relying on any third-party summary (Pennie, 2026b).

YOUR CONSUMER PROTECTIONS

If a directory error sends you out-of-network: 28 Pa. Code § 9.725 caps your liability at in-network cost-sharing, and Act 252 of 2023 presumes an undisclosed out-of-network balance bill illegal. The federal IDR process (45 C.F.R. § 149.510) is a *provider-vs-plan* tool only — you cannot file one yourself; use the protections above instead.

Enroll / compare plans: pennie.com or 1-844-844-8040	File a complaint: pa.gov/consumer or 1-866-722-6675
Free legal help: phlp.org or 1-800-274-3258	Medicare counseling: PA MEDI 1-800-783-7067

SOURCES (APA)

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- Pennsylvania Insurance Department. (2025b). *Coverage areas, individual market, 2026*. pa.gov/agencies/insurance/posted-filings-reports-company-orders/product-and-rate-filings/aca-health-rate-filings/coverage-areas-individual-market
- Spotlight PA. (2026, July 1). *PA's budget is late for the 5th year in a row*. spotlightpa.org
- WITF. (2025, Oct. 17). *Health insurance rates... double-digit increase in 2026*. witf.org